

7.1 SUPERVISION AND AUTHENTICATION OF INTERNALLY ASSESSED WORK

OCR expects teachers to supervise and guide candidates who are undertaking work which is internally assessed (e.g. coursework). The degree of teacher guidance in candidates' work will vary according to the kinds of work being undertaken. It should be remembered, however, that candidates are required to reach their own judgements and conclusions.

When supervising internally assessed tasks, teachers are expected to:

- offer candidates advice about how best to approach such tasks;
- guide a candidate's choice of topic by pointing out the nature and difficulties of those offered, and the facilities available either in the Centre or elsewhere;
- suggest methods of research, and propose alternative avenues of enquiry if a candidate runs into difficulty. Written notes must be kept if extra guidance is given;
- exercise continuing supervision of work in order to monitor progress and to prevent plagiarism;
- advise candidates about the presentation of the final work. Group enquiries may be carried out provided that each candidate has a clearly recognisable aspect of the enquiry so that the work of the individual may be clearly distinguished;
- ensure that the work is completed in accordance with the specification requirements and can be assessed in accordance with the specified marking criteria and procedures;
- certify that the marks shown were awarded in accordance with OCR's instructions. Any assistance given to particular candidates, which is beyond that given to the group as a whole, but within the parameters outlined above, must be recorded on the Assessment Form. Teachers must show clearly how the marks have been awarded in relation to the marking criteria defined in the specification by annotating the work of the candidates;
- declare that the tasks were completed within ethical guidelines. Declarations should be completed by each teacher in the Centre responsible for a GCSE Psychology group.

Internally assessed work should be completed in the course of normal curriculum time and supervised and marked by the teacher. Some of the work, by its very nature, may be undertaken outside the Centre (for example, research work, testing). As with all internally assessed work, the teacher must be satisfied that work submitted for assessment is the candidate's own.